1. Repairing relations with the Soviet Union with a view to ensuring the supply of weapons. This was after the expulsion of the Soviets from Egypt in July 1972.
2. Conducting a comprehensive campaign to gain diplomatic support, with the main focus being western Europe, along with efforts among the nonaligned and Latin American countries.
3. Raising the issue at the UN General Assembly, and after it (in 1973) at a special UN Security Council meeting to approve the Egyptian interpretation of Resolution 242.
4. Maintaining contacts with the United States.
5. Maintaining contact with the Arab states in order to bring about the exertion of pressure with regard to Western interests.
6. Recruitment of the "domestic front" in Egypt.
7. Taking into account that a military clash between Egypt and Israel and the United States was almost inevitable. (My interpretation of the inclusion of the United States in this phrase is that it was only figurative/emotional and was not intended to suggest a clash between Egyptian and American military forces.)
8. Considering the possibility of limited Egyptian military action in the winter of 1972–73.

The crux of Ismail's view was that Egypt should rely mainly on "diplomatic action," in which the military forces would play only a supplementary role. And indeed, Egypt did carry out most of Ismail's plan, though the military campaign was postponed until October 1973. The results of the Egyptian diplomatic efforts were evident on the eve of the war, during it, and in its wake.

## The "Détente" and Its Implications for the Conflict

The "détente"—the process of the thawing of relations between the two blocs, which began in the late 1960s—convinced the Egyptian leadership that there was no longer any chance for diplomatic efforts and that it could not rely on the two powers for salvation, especially not after the second summit of the leaders of the United States and the Soviet Union in